Sample HPC Part B activity

A real activity from PARAKH's Activity Bank, to copy the structure and tone from when writing new ones.

Stage	Preparatory
Grade	Grade 4 (as tagged on PARAKH)
Subject	Language 1 (R1)
Curricular goal	L1CG4
Competency	L1C4.1
Name on PARAKH	L1CG4,C-4.1

1. Activity description

Text for Activity: The teacher reads this short passage aloud once. Then, students receive the printed passage and read it silently.
Passage: The Unexpected Visitor: One cloudy afternoon, Meena heard a faint sound near the school garden. She walked slowly towards the bushes and found a tiny puppy shivering under a bench. The puppy looked frightened, but it did not run away. Meena gently called the gardener and asked for help. The gardener brought a cloth and placed the puppy in a safe corner. Soon, a group of children gathered around, but Meena reminded them to stay calm and not crowd the little animal. By the end of the day, the puppy looked more comfortable, and the class decided to inform the nearby animal shelter.
Materials Required:
● Printed passage/written on the students worksheet
● Pencil
● Small “Word Detective” slips
● Board/chart paper
Activity Flow
Step 1: Listening for Words
The teacher reads the passage aloud. Students listen carefully and put a small dot near any word they find:
● new , interesting , difficult , important for understanding the passage
Examples may include: faint, shivering, frightened, gently, gathered, calm, crowd, comfortable, shelter.
Step 2: Reading and Choosing Words
Students read the passage silently. Each student chooses three words:
1. One word they already know but want to explain
2. One word they are unsure about
3. One word they think is important for the passage
They write these words on their Word Detective slip.
Step 3: Meaning from Context
For each selected word, students write or orally explain:
● What do I think this word means? , Which words or sentence clues helped me ? , Can I say it using another word or phrase
Example: For shivering, a student may use clues like cloudy afternoon, tiny puppy, under a bench, and understand that the puppy was shaking because it was cold or scared.
Step 4: Word Discussion Circle
Students sit in groups of four. Each student shares one word and its possible meaning. Other group members can add:
● a synonym , a sentence clue , a real-life example , a better explanation
The teacher observes how students discuss meaning, listen to different explanations, and improve their vocabulary.
Step 5: Vocabulary Use
Each student chooses two words from the group discussion and writes one fresh sentence for each. The sentence must show the meaning clearly.
Example: The old man spoke gently to the crying child. , Not enough: Gently is a good word.

2. Assessment

Q1. Which word did you understand by using sentence clues from the passage? Explain the clue you used.
Q2. How did your meaning of one word change or become clearer after listening to your group?
Q3. When a classmate gave a meaning that was not fully correct, how did you help them improve it using the passage?
Q4. Which word from the passage shows care, fear, or comfort? How did discussing that word help you understand the situation better?
Q5. Use one new word from the passage in your own sentence, but in a different situation.
Q6. Create a small word web for one selected word using a synonym, an opposite word, and one real-life example.

3. Rubric

Each ability has three levels. Every text names what the child visibly does in this activity.

Ability	Beginner	Proficient	Advanced
Awareness	The student selects words from the passage but may explain them by guessing or by repeating the sentence without showing the meaning. The student may identify a difficult word, such as faint or shivering, but the explanation may remain incomplete, such as “faint means sound” or “shivering means puppy.” The student needs support to use sentence clues, synonyms, and surrounding words to understand meaning.	The student uses context clues to explain word meanings. The student can connect a word with nearby clues in the passage and give a simple synonym or phrase. For example, for shivering, the student links tiny puppy under a bench with cold or scared. For shelter, the student explains it as a safe place for animals. The student shows vocabulary growth by correcting or improving one meaning after group discussion.	The student explains word meaning using more than one vocabulary strategy: context clue, synonym, opposite, example, and sentence use. For example, the student explains faint as a very soft sound, connects it with Meena heard it near the garden, and uses it in a new sentence: “I heard a faint knock during the rain.” The student shows that listening and reading both helped them refine the meaning.
Sensitivity	The student participates in word discussion but may correct others directly or focus only on giving their own answer. For example, the student may say “No, that is wrong” when a classmate explains crowd as people coming near. The student may notice feeling words like frightened or comfortable, but may not connect them clearly to the puppy’s situation.	The student discusses meanings respectfully and uses the passage to help others. For example, the student says, “Crowd means many people coming too close; the passage says Meena told them not to crowd the puppy.” The student understands feeling words such as frightened, gentle, calm, and comfortable and explains how these words show care for the puppy.	The student improves group discussion by adding careful, text-based explanations and respecting different attempts. For example, the student says, “Your meaning is close. ‘Crowd’ here does not only mean people gathering; it means going too close and making the puppy uncomfortable.” The student connects vocabulary to feelings and behaviour, such as explaining that gently shows Meena’s care, while frightened and shivering show the puppy’s fear.
Creativity	The student uses a new word in a sentence, but the sentence may not clearly show the meaning. For example, “The puppy was comfortable” or “I saw a shelter.” The sentence is related, but it does not prove that the student understands the word. The word web may include only one part, such as just a synonym.	The student uses new vocabulary correctly in a fresh sentence and creates a simple word web. For example, “My grandmother spoke gently when my little brother was crying.” For example, the student may write synonym scared, " the opposite of " brave/calm, and an example of a child hearing thunder. The sentence and word web show a clear understanding.	The student uses vocabulary flexibly in a new context and builds a complete word web with meaningful links. For example, for comfort, the student writes the synonym relaxed, the opposite of uneasy, and an example “I felt comfortable after my friend saved me a seat.” The student’s new sentence is not copied from the passage and clearly shows the word’s meaning through situation, feeling, or action.

4. When you write a new one

• Set stage, grade and subject first; then take a curricular goal and competency of that subject.
• Name it "<goal>,<competency>" as PARAKH does.
• Activity description: a title, a short passage or story for the grade, materials, then Step 1 to Step 5.
• Assessment: 4 to 6 numbered questions the teacher asks after the activity.
• Rubric: Beginner = with support, Proficient = on their own, Advanced = extends it, with a quoted example.
• Middle stage only: Approach = Any Other, with the goal and competency typed in.
• No pictures: the app cannot use activities with pictures.